CARROM TOURNAMENT RULEBOOK

ANNUAL SPORTS FEST • IIIT VADODARA (GN) • VENTURA 2K26

Official Tournament Draft

This rulebook sets out the playing conditions, conduct expectations, and match procedures for the annual sports fest. The Sports Committee should announce any tournament-specific choices before matches begin.

1. TOURNAMENT CATEGORIES

- **Singles:** One player competes against one player.
- **Doubles:** Two players compete as a team against another team of two.
- Open to eligible B.Tech, MCA, and M.Tech students across all batches, subject to the event registration notice.

2. MATCH FORMAT & REPORTING

- The default format is **knockout** unless the organizers announce otherwise.
- Each match is recommended to be **best of three boards**; the first player/team to win two boards wins the match.
- The final may be **best of five boards** if announced in advance.
- The organizers will publish the draw, schedule, venue, and reporting time.
- A player/team that does not report within the announced grace period may forfeit the match.

3. EQUIPMENT AND SEATING

- The organizers will provide the board, carrom men, and striker, unless stated otherwise.
- In singles, players sit opposite one another. In doubles, teammates sit opposite one another.
- Use only the striker approved for the event.
- Players must not lift, tilt, shake, or move the board during play.

4. BASIC PLAYING RULES

- The referee determines who starts, by toss or another announced method.
- The striker must be placed within the player's permitted baseline area and flicked with a finger.
- Pushing, throwing, or otherwise propelling the striker illegally is not permitted.
- A player continues their turn after legally pocketing one or more of their own carrom men; otherwise, the turn passes to the opponent.
- Players must not touch or reposition carrom men by hand or with another object during play.
- If a coin or striker leaves the board, stop play and ask the referee to restore the position under the event's adopted rules.

5. QUEEN (RED CARROM MAN)

Queen Rules: The red carrom man is called the Queen. The Queen must be covered by legally pocketing one of the player's/team's own carrom men on the same turn or the next eligible turn, as determined by the adopted rules. If the Queen is not covered, it is returned to the centre in accordance with the referee's ruling. Players should ask the referee to clarify any Queen-related situation before play resumes.

6. FOULS AND PENALTIES

- **Pocketing the striker** is a foul.
- Making an illegal strike, playing from outside the permitted area, or striking out of turn may be called a foul.
- Improperly touching or moving carrom men, disturbing the board, or deliberately distracting an opponent is not allowed.

- The turn ends after a foul. Where required by the adopted rules, a previously pocketed carrom man is returned as a **penalty coin**.
- The referee will apply the announced penalty consistently. The exact penalty procedure should be confirmed before the tournament.

7. SCORING

Outcome	Points Awarded
Winning a Board	1 point for each opposing carrom man left on the board.
Pocketing & Covering Queen	3 additional points (subject to scoring rules announced before play).
Foul (Striker Pocketed / Illegal Strike)	Turn ends; 1 penalty coin returned to centre if applicable.

The organizers must confirm whether they will use this simplified scoring or the full official scoring system before the event starts. Any scoring objection must be raised before the next board begins.

8. DOUBLES-SPECIFIC RULES

- Both teammates must be registered and eligible participants.
- Teammates sit opposite each other and take turns in the order directed by the referee.
- Teammates may communicate between turns but must not distract an opponent during a strike.
- Substitutions after a match begins are not allowed unless explicitly approved by the organizers.

9. CONDUCT AND SPORTSMANSHIP

- Treat opponents, teammates, referees, and organizers respectfully.
- Abusive language, cheating, intentional distraction, or unsporting behaviour may result in a warning or disqualification.
- Spectators must not interfere with an ongoing match. Raise concerns politely and promptly with the referee.

10. DISPUTES, DISQUALIFICATION & ORGANIZER CHECKLIST

- Raise an objection immediately after the incident and before the next turn begins.
- The referee may pause play briefly to hear the issue and make a ruling. Repeated misconduct or refusal to follow instructions leads to disqualification.
- **Checklist:** Organizers confirm whether the final is best of three or five boards, announce grace period, time limit per board, and assign referees.

11. FINAL AUTHORITY

Participation implies acceptance of the announced tournament rules. The Sports Committee may make reasonable operational changes and will communicate them before they affect play. The referee's on-board decisions are final for the event, subject to any appeal procedure announced by the Sports Committee.

"Play fair. Respect your opponent. Let your skills decide the winner!"

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